Planning

Que. What is planning?

Ans. According to Koontz and O'Donnell "Planning is an intellectual process, conscious determination of a course of action, the basing of a decision on purpose, facts and considered estimates."

Planning is deciding in advance what to do and how to do. It is one of the basic managerial functions. It involves setting objectives and developing appropriate courses of action to achieve these objectives.

Que. What are the features of planning?

Ans. **Following are the features of planning:-**



1. Planning focuses on achieving objectives:- Setting goals and creating an action plan are both parts of planning. Planning is primarily used for helping individuals, groups, and corporations in anticipating and preparing for upcoming events as well as choosing the best course of action to accomplish their desired goals.

2. Planning is a primary function of management:- Planning is the first step in the management process and lays the foundation for the other functions. Planning involves setting objectives, determining the actions necessary to achieve those objectives, and developing strategies for the efficient use of resources.

3.Planning is pervasive:- Planning is required at all levels of management as well as in all departments of the organisation. The scope of planning is different at different levels and for different departments.

4.Planning is continuous:- The process of planning is ongoing. It doesn't happen only once at the start of a project or campaign. Instead, planning is a continuous process that requires regular evaluation and revision as conditions change.

5.Planning is futuristic:- The purpose of planning is to meet future events effectively to the best advantage of and organisation. Planning involves forecasting future events and conditions and drafting the plans accordingly.

6. Planning involves decision-making: Planning essentially involves a choice among various alternatives and activities. If there is only one possible goal or a possible course of action, there is no need for planning because there is no choice.

7. Planning is a mental exercise: Planning requires the application of the mind involving foresight. Planning is an intellectual activity, which requires logical and systematic thinking rather than guesswork.

Que. Expalin the importance of planning.

Ans. **Importance of planning are as follows:-**

1.Planning provides directions: By stating in advance, how the work is to be done planning provides direction for action. Planning ensures that objectives are clearly stated in order to develop appropriate course of action. If the plans are set, the department and individuals can work in coordination.

2.Planning reduces the risk of uncertainty: Planning is an activity, which enables a manager to look ahead and anticipate changes. Changes or events cannot be eliminated but by deciding the plans and course of action in advance managers can anticipate it and adjust the plans according to the situation.

3.Planning reduces overlapping and wasteful activities: Planning serves as the basis of coordinating the activities and efforts of different divisions departments and individuals. It reduces useless and redundant activities, avoids confusion and misunderstanding, and ensures clarity in thought and action.

4. Planning promotes innovative ideas: Planning is the first function of management. Managers get the opportunity to develop new ideas and new ideas can take the shape of concrete plans. It guides all future actions leading to the growth and prosperity of the business.

5. Planning facilitates decision-making: Planning involves setting targets and predicting future conditions, thus helping in taking rational decisions from alternative courses of action.

6. Planning establishes standards for controlling: Planning provides the standards against which the actual performance is measured. Therefore planning is a prerequisite for controlling.

Que. What are the limitations of planning?

Ans. **Limitations of planning are as follows:-**



1. Planning leads to rigidity:- Managers may not be able to alter a well-defined strategy that has been created for an organization with specific goals to be reached within a given time frame. Because of the dynamic nature of the business environment managers need to be given a chance to adapt to unforeseen circumstances.

2. Planning may not work in a dynamic environment: Planning is based on anticipation of future happenings and since the future is uncertain and dynamic so the organization needs to adapt itself to changes. However, planning cannot foresee future events effectively.

3.Planning reduces creativity: Planning reduces creativity since top management plans and middle management carries out the plan but is not permitted to vary from it. As a result, these managers' originality is reduced.

4.Planning involves huge costs:- The plan's creation involves significant expenses. To determine data for detailed planning, scientific computations are needed. Sometimes the costs of preparing are less than the rewards gained.

5.Planning is a time consuming:- Making a plan takes a lot of time because there are many factors to take into account.

6.Planning does not guarantee success:- Only when plans are adequately created and carried out is an organization likely to succeed. Managers frequently implement tried-and-true strategies, but not all situations allow them to a strategy that worked in the past.

Que. What is the process of planning?

Ans. **Process of planning are as follows:-**



1. Setting up of the objectives:- This process involves deciding what must be accomplished, setting goals, and establishing the results that will indicate success.

2. Developing Premises:- The managers are obligated to make certain assumptions while making plans for the organization because planning is a future-focused activity and the future is uncertain.

These future-related assumptions are known as premises, and they serve as the foundation for creating plans. The assumption made should be understood by and accepted by all management involved in planning.

3. Listing the various alternatives for achieving the objectives:- After goals are established, assumptions are developed, and then various possibilities of action are chosen. To accomplish the goals of the company, managers must determine all possible alternative courses of action. The strategy could be conventional or innovative. By involving more people and encouraging them to share their ideas, innovative courses can be accepted.

4.Evaluation of different alternatives:- The next stage is evaluating the advantages and disadvantages of each potential course of action.The objectives to be reached should be taken into consideration when evaluating the positive and negative aspects of each proposal.

5. Selecting an alternative:- Out of all the options, the best strategy is picked and put into action. The best strategy is one that is most workable, profitable, and has the fewest bad effects. Since a mathematical analysis is typically not possible when creating a plan, the manager's expertise, judgment, and perception are crucial in choosing the best course of action. On certain occasions, a combination of plans may be chosen instead of the single optimum approach.

6. Implementing the plan:- This step involves putting the best strategy that was chosen into effect. Managers begin gathering and organizing the necessary materials to carry out the strategy.

7.Follow-up:- It involves keeping an eye on the execution of the plans and making sure that the tasks are being completed on time.To meet organizational goals, corrective action must be implemented once continuous monitoring identifies deviations from plans.

Que. What Single use plan?

Ans.Plans for a single usage are specific plans created to meet a one-time need. It was created for a one-time attempt or event with a single, clear goal.Such a plan is created to deal with the requirements of the particular circumstance at hand. A single event plan may run for one day, whereas a single project may last for one week or months. Accordingly, the length of a single use plan varies based on the type of project.

Que. What is the standing plan?

Ans. For those actions that take place frequently throughout time, standing plans are used. It is created once and maintains its value over time while undergoing upgrades and alterations. It is created once and occasionally changed to suit business requirements. Policies, procedures, methods, and rules are all part of standing plans.

Que. What is objectives?

Ans. The results that the management hopes to attain at the end of its activities are called objectives.They could be created with the management's ideal future position in mind. The establishment of organizational objectives is the first and most important phase in the planning process.Objectives must be stated in detail, be quantifiably measurable, and take the form of a written statement of the desired outcomes to be attained within a certain time frame.

Que. What is Strategy?

Ans. Future choices that define the direction and scope of an organisation over the long term are referred to as strategy. Are those strategies that a company uses to get ready for different chances, threats, and scenarios.The term "internal strategy" refers to a new business strategy developed by an organization's managers, whereas the term "external strategy" refers to a strategy developed in response to a competitor's business strategy.

Que. What is a policy?

Ans. Policies are broad declarations that stay through or focus energy in a specific direction. It offers a foundation for analyzing strategy. There are big policies and smaller policies for all the levels and departments inside an organization. The limits of a manager's authority are set by policies. They are adaptable because they can be altered to meet needs.

For instance, only accepting cash as payment for items, making purchases, etc.

Que. What is a Procedure ?

Ans. Procedures are regular processes that specify how a task is to be carried out exactly.They list the tasks that must be completed in what order.In general, the order of steps to be followed is to uphold a policy and achieve pre-established goals.

For instance, a company's hiring procedure.

Que. What is a Rule ?

Ans. Rules are specific instructions that specify what to do and what not to do in certain situations.The rigidity of the rules prevents flexibility, which maintains order in the workplace.

For instance "No smoking in the office premises."

Que. What is the method?

Ans. The prescribed ways or manner in which a work can be carried out while taking the objective into account are provided by methods. Selecting the right approach boosts efficiency while saving time, money, and effort. Methods can be changed.

For example:-Various methods of training adopted by an organization to train its employees like apprenticeship training, induction programs, etc.

Que. What is a Programme?

Ans.A programme may include an in-depth description of the project's objectives, policies, processes, rules, tasks, and the people and physical resources needed to carry out any course of action.

Que. What is Budget?

Ans.A budget is a declaration of what is expected outcomes explained in monetary terms for a predetermined time period in the future.